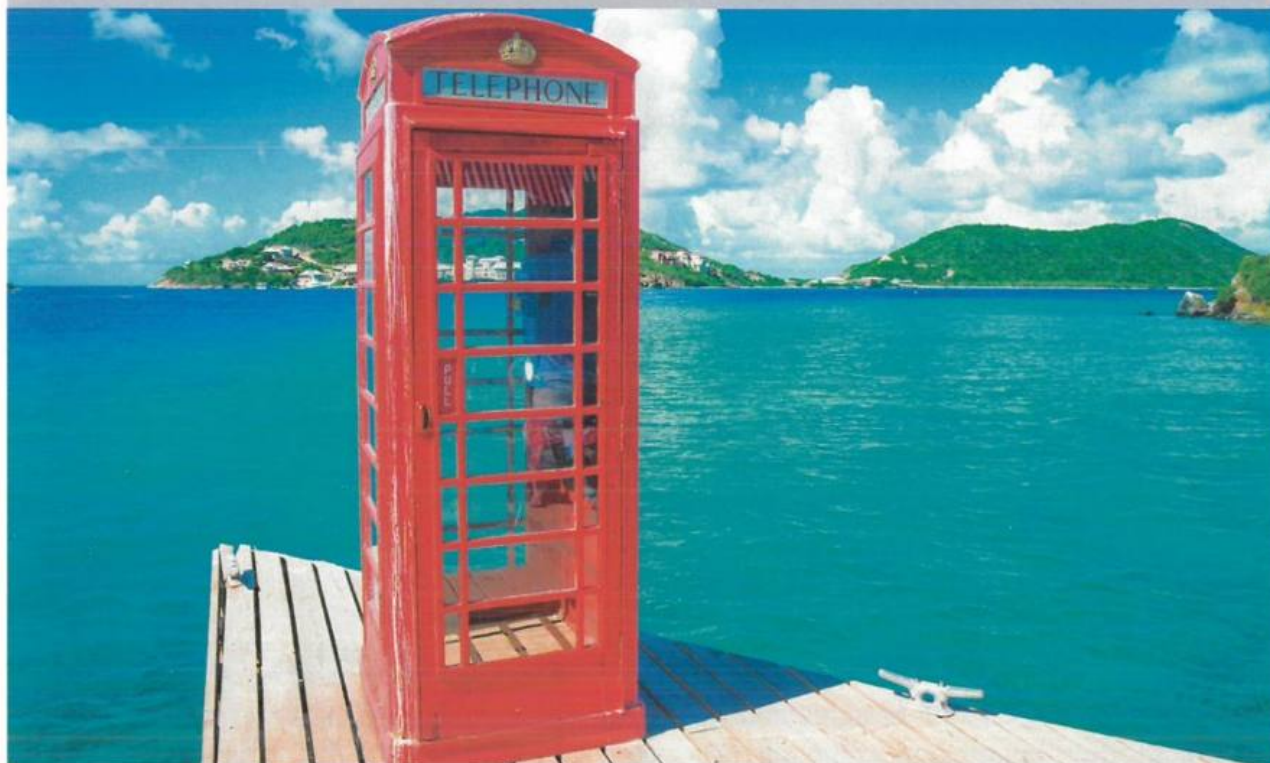


Post-reading activities



Part A

Reviewing colonial and post-colonial challenges

A1 A colonial experience:

'An Outpost of Progress' *Joseph Conrad*

In Joseph Conrad's short story 'An Outpost of Progress', a trading company sends two incompetent employees, Kayerts and Carlier, to a remote trading post in Congo. Read the following excerpt from the text and complete the tasks that follow on p. 60.

Carlier said one evening, waving his hand about, 'In a hundred years, there will be perhaps a town here. Quays, and warehouses, and barracks, and – and – billiard-rooms. Civilization, my boy, and virtue – and all. And then, chaps will read that two good fellows, Kayerts and

5 Carlier, were the first civilized men to live in this very spot!' [...]

² **quay** [ki:] platform to board, load or unload ships

³ **virtue** ['vɜ:tʃu:] morally good behaviour

⁴ **chap** (infml, BE) guy, man

On the ground before the door of the fetish lay six splendid tusks.

'What did you give for it?' asked Kayerts, after surveying the lot with satisfaction.

'No regular trade,' said Makola. 'They brought the ivory and gave it to me. I told them to take what they most wanted in the station. It is a beautiful lot. No station can show such tusks. Those traders wanted carriers badly, and our men were no good here. No trade, no entry in books: all correct.'

Kayerts nearly burst with indignation. 'Why!' he shouted, 'I believe you have sold our men for these tusks!' Makola stood impassive and silent. 'I – I – will – I,' stuttered Kayerts. 'You fiend!' he yelled out.

'I did the best for you and the Company,' said Makola, imperturbably. 'Why you shout so much? Look at this tusk.'

'I dismiss you! I will report you – I won't look at the tusk. I forbid you to touch them. I order you to throw them into the river. You – you!'

'You very red, Mr. Kayerts. If you are so irritable in the sun, you will get fever and die – like the first chief!' pronounced Makola impressively. [...]

Carlier came back on the verandah. 'They're all gone, hey?' asked Kayerts from the far end of the common room in a muffled voice. 'You did not find anybody?'

'Oh, yes,' said Carlier, 'I found one of Gobila's people lying dead before the huts – shot through the body. We heard that shot last night.'

Kayerts came out quickly. He found his companion staring grimly over the yard at the tusks, away by the store. They both sat in silence for a while. Then Kayerts related his conversation with Makola. Carlier said nothing. At the midday meal they ate very little. They hardly exchanged a word that day. A great silence seemed to lie heavily over the station and press on their lips. Makola did not open the store; he spent the day playing with his children. He lay full-length on a mat outside his door, and the youngsters sat on his chest and clambered all over him. It was a touching picture. Mrs. Makola was busy cooking all day, as usual. The white men made a somewhat better meal in the evening. Afterwards, Carlier smoking his pipe strolled over to the store; he stood for a long time over the tusks, touched one or two with his foot, even tried to lift the largest one by its small end. He came back to his chief, who had not stirred from the verandah, threw himself in the chair and said –

'I can see it! They were pounced upon while they slept heavily after drinking all that palm wine you've allowed Makola to give them. A put-up job! See? The worst is, some of Gobila's people were there, and got carried off too, no doubt. The least drunk woke up, and got shot for his sobriety. This is a funny country. What will you do now?'

'We can't touch it, of course,' said Kayerts.

'Of course not,' assented Carlier.

⁶ **tusk** long, curved tooth that pokes out of an elephant's mouth

¹⁴ **indignation** outrage

¹⁶ **fiend** [fi:nd] unfriendly, evil person

¹⁷ **imperturbable** [ˌɪmpə'tɜ:bəl] undis- turbed, calm

²⁴ **muffled** gedämpft

³⁵ **clamber** ['klæmbə] (v) climb with difficulty

⁴¹ **stir** (v) (here) move

⁴³ **pounce on sb.** jump on sb. to attack them

⁴⁵ **put-up job** abgekar- tetes Spiel

⁴⁹ **assent to sth./sb.** [ə'sent] agree with sth./sb.



50 'Slavery is an awful thing,' stammered out Kayerts in an unsteady voice.

'Frightful – the sufferings,' grunted Carlier with conviction.

They believed their words. Everybody shows a respectful deference to certain sounds that he and his fellows can make. But about feelings
55 people really know nothing. We talk with indignation or enthusiasm; we talk about oppression, cruelty, crime, devotion, self-sacrifice, virtue, and we know nothing real beyond the words. Nobody knows what suffering or sacrifice mean – except, perhaps the victims of the mysterious purpose of these illusions.

60 Next morning they saw Makola very busy setting up in the yard the big scales used for weighing ivory. [...] Carlier said to Kayerts in a careless tone: 'I say, chief, I might just as well give him a lift with this lot into the store.'

As they were going back to the house Kayerts observed with a sigh:

65 'It had to be done.' And Carlier said: 'It's deplorable, but, the men being Company's men the ivory is Company's ivory. We must look after it.'

From: Korff und Ringel-Eichinger. *One Language Many Voices*, pp. 18; 25–28. Cornelsen: 2009.

53 deference

[ˈdefərəns] respect for sb./sth.

56 devotion dedication, commitment

65 deplorable

[dɪˈplɔːrəbl] regrettable

Comprehension

- 1 Describe how Kayerts and Carlier perceive their role in the first paragraph.
- 2 Outline the elements of the deal between Makola and the traders.
- 3 Describe how Makola and the two Europeans behave in the aftermath of the dreadful night.

Analysis

- 4 Examine the language (→ Info box, p. 32) Kayerts and Carlier use and how they express their disapproval of Makola's secret deal.
- 5 Compare Makola to Kayerts and Carlier and explain why the two Europeans are only formally in charge of the trading post.



Beyond the text

6 YOU CHOOSE

- a **Writing** Write Kayerts's diary entry two days after the nightly incident.
OR
- b **Speaking** Act out a dialogue between Makola and a friend in which he brags about his successful deal.
- 7 Comment on the title of the story and discuss the ways in which Joseph Conrad criticizes colonialism in his short story.

A2 The London bombings on 7 July 2005

Read the following newspaper blurbs and complete the tasks that follow on pp. 62–63.

On July 7, 2005, four suicide bombers targeted London's transport network at the height of morning rush hour. Backpack bombs were detonated on three underground trains and a bus. Fifty-two people were killed and more than 700 were injured. [...]

5 John Falding's partner, Anat Rosenberg, was killed that morning when one of the bombers blew himself up on a double-decker bus. [...]

0 And so we lay on the bed and just cuddled, and I held her for a quarter of an hour. That quarter of an hour, that quarter of an hour, that cuddle, really killed her. Because she left at 9 o'clock instead of a quarter to 9. If she'd left at the usual time, she would've missed the bomb.

From: Rich Presto, Ari, Sharipo, The Painful memories of Those Who Survived London's 2005 Terror Attacks, National Public Radio, 7 July 2015

The bombers' journey began at 04:00 BST as three of the group – Mohammad Sidique Khan, 30, Shehzad Tanweer, 22, and 18-year-old Hasib Hussain – left Leeds, West Yorkshire, in a rented car bound for Luton, Bedfordshire. There they met their
5 fourth accomplice, 19-year-old Germaine Lindsay, before heading to the capital by train.

They went on to detonate four devices – three on the Underground and one on a double-decker bus.

From: 7 July London Bombings: What Happened That Day? BBC News, 3 July 2015

In one sense the meaning of 7/7 is as clear to Britons as that of 9/11 is to Americans. It was a savage, brutal attack intended to sow mayhem and terror. Yet whereas 9/11 was the work of a foreign terrorist group, 7/7 was the work of British citizens. The question
5 that haunts London, but that Washington has so far barely had to face, is why four men brought up in Britain were gripped by such fanatic zeal for a murderous, medieval dogma. [...]

Many second-generation British Muslims now find themselves detached from both the religious traditions of their parents, which
10 they often reject, and the wider secular society that insists on viewing them simply as Muslims. A few are drawn inevitably to extremist Islamist groups where they discover a sense of identity and of belonging. It is this that has made them open to radicalization.

From: Kenan Malik, Assimilation's Failure, Terrorism's Rise, The New York Times, 6 July 2020

¹ **BST** British Standard Time

² **savage** ['sævidʒ] (n)
(here) person who is uncivilized and violent

³ **mayhem** chaos

⁵ **haunt sb./sth.** (v)
(here) trouble sb./sth.

⁷ **zeal** eagerness, enthusiasm

⁹ **detached** (here) disconnected

[London's mayor, Sadiq Khan]: 'The way that our city responded and stood united in the aftermath of the attack showed the world that our values of decency, tolerance and mutual respect will always overcome the hate of the terrorists.'

³ **decency** ['di:snsi]
respectful behaviour
mutual ['mju:tʃuəl]
gegenseitig

From: 7/7 London Bombings: Mayor Pays Tributes to Victims, *BBC News*, 7 July 2020

Comprehension

- 1 Decide whether the following statements are true (T) or false (F) by ticking the box. If the statement is false, correct it in the space provided.

Statement	T	F
A Four suicide bombers killed 52 people in a dreadful attack in London.		
Correction: _____		
B Anat Rosenberg was killed because she took an earlier train.		
Correction: _____		
C The three terrorists travelled to London where they planted bombs in a rental car and a double-decker bus.		
Correction: _____		
D The terrorists were immigrants from Jamaica.		
Correction: _____		
E Many second-generation immigrants feel rootless, which makes them susceptible to radicalization.		
Correction: _____		
F London's mayor, Sadiq Khan, vowed that terrorists would never succeed in shattering the nation's solidarity.		
Correction: _____		

Analysis

- 2 Examine the choice of words in the news excerpts. (→ Info box, p. 32).
How are they used to express the horror of the attacks?
- 3 Point out possible causes for the aggression.

Beyond the text

- 4 a **Think:** Come up with the three most important challenges immigrants are facing and how to tackle them.
- b **Pair:** Compare your ideas with a partner.
- c **Share:** **Speaking** Present your findings to the class.

A3 A multicultural experience: 'A Pair of Jeans' Qaisra Shahraz

In this excerpt from the short story 'A Pair of Jeans', a second-generation immigrant, Miriam, lives a double life caught between the traditional culture of her parents and the modern British life she has grown up with. She is engaged to her fiancée, Farook, whose parents, Ayub and Begum, are visiting. When Miriam returns home, they have already arrived and see her wearing Western clothes. Read the following excerpt from the text and complete the tasks that follow on p. 64.

'Deny it as much as you like, Miriam,' her heart whispered back. 'It's no use. They have seen another side of you – your other persona.'

The other 'persona' had apparently, by either sheer accident or mere contrivance, remained hidden from them from the very beginning.

- 5 When they first saw her at a party, she was dressed in a maroon chiffon sari and later on each occasion she was always smartly but discreetly and respectably dressed in a traditional shalwar kameeze suit. Never at any time had they glimpsed a jean-clad Miriam with an inch of midriff showing! In fact, judging by her mother's expression and lack of composure, it must have been a nasty shock! For now, they were seeing her as a young college woman who was very much under the sway of Western fashion and by extension its moral values. Muslim girls do not go outdoors dressed like that, especially in the short jacket, which hardly covered her hips and a skimpy vest. She had heard of stories about in-laws who were prejudiced against such girls. For they weren't the docile, the obedient and sweet daughter-in-laws that they preferred. On the contrary, they were seen as a threat and portrayed as rebellious *hoydens*, who did not respect either their husbands or their in-laws. Miriam was all too familiar with such stereotyped views of women. [...]

[Ayub]: 'Well, what do you think of your future daughter-in-law? I thought you told me she was a very "sharif", a very modest girl. Was that naked waist what you would call modest? He lanced at her. [...]

⁴ **contrivance**

[kən'traɪvəns]
(fml) clever plan

⁵ **maroon** [mə'ru:n]

brownish red colour

chiffon ['ʃɪfən] type of material you can see through, usually for clothing

⁶ **sari** ['sɑ:ri] long traditional cloth worn around the body, esp. worn by women in South Asia

⁷ **shalwar kameez** [ʃəl'wɑ: kə'mi:z] traditional dress

⁸ **glimpse sth.** (v) see sth.

⁹ **midriff** ['- -] waist

¹² **sway** (n) power, influence

¹⁴ **skimpy** (here) small, not covering much of the body

¹⁶ **docile** ['dəʊsaɪl] well-behaved and obedient

¹⁸ **hoyden** wild girl

²³ **lance at sb.** (v) (here) attack sb. verbally

‘Tell me, in those clothes of hers, would you be proud to have her
 25 as your daughter-in-law? I know I am not. You talk about her being
 a university student. Well, have you any idea what sort of company
 that she might be keeping with that lot. You’ve only seen her at odd
 times, and always at home. Do you know what she is really like? Have
 you thought of the effect she could have in your household? With
 30 her lifestyle, such girls also want a lot of freedom. In fact, they want
 to lead their lives the way their English college friends do. Did you
 notice what time she came in? She knew we were coming, yet that had
 not made any difference to her lifestyle. So you expect her to change
 overnight to suit us? People form habits, Begum, do you understand?
 35 Are you prepared for a daughter-in-law who goes in and out of the
 house whenever she feels like it, dressed like that and returns home as
 late as that? Don’t your cheeks burn at the thought of that bit of flesh
 you saw? Imagine how our son will feel about her! I hope shame! And
 what if she has a boyfriend already – have you thought of that? What
 40 if she has a boyfriend already? What if she takes drugs? What if ...
 What if ... So many questions to ask ourselves! Do you know, we do
 not know this girl at all, Begum! Can you guarantee that she will make
 our son happy?’

From: ‘A Pair of Jeans’. In: Korff und Ringel-Eichinger. *One Language Many Voices*,
 pp. 178; 182–183, Cornelsen: 2009.

Comprehension

- 1 Describe Miriam’s expectations.
- 2 Outline her future in-laws’ fears.

Analysis

- 3 Illustrate Ayub’s view of British society.

Beyond the text

- 4 a With a partner, prepare a dialogue in which Ayub challenges a
 British neighbour’s view of society.
 b **Speaking** Act out your dialogue.
- 5 Discuss the role of arranged marriage in different societies.



Die Unterrichtsmaterialien *Great Britain: Past and Present: A multicultural society with a colonial past*

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